

# Second Pass — real catches from real ad scripts

A Meta video-ad editor for laser tattoo removal clinics. It critiques; it never rewrites — it names the exact beat, the standard it breaks, and hands the work back. Four findings below, from real ad scripts — including one from a working realtor in a different industry.

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## CATCH 01

### The one person who has to be real... isn't.

Source: “old-home-surprises” — a real ad from a working real estate agent (Melissa Bonina, Custom Homes Realty)

#### THE CATCH

All seven beats are AI-generated — including beat 6, whose entire job is trust: “*Melissa arrives, reviewing inspection paperwork with buyers. Everyone relaxes.*” In a business where the product is her judgment, the ad contains no real her, no real home she sold, and no real client. Flagged separately: a realistic AI depiction of a real, named person can trigger Meta’s AI-disclosure rules — verify before it runs.

#### HANDED BACK — NOT REWRITTEN

*“Can beats 6 and 7 be real footage of Melissa? It’s the cheapest real footage in the whole ad, it’s the only beat that has to be believed, and it retires the disclosure question in the same stroke.”*

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## CATCH 02

### A Fair Housing landmine, caught by swapping one file.

Source: the **real-estate** profile — same editor, different industry, zero changes to the core

#### THE CATCH

“Perfect for families” flags as familial-status steering. “Safe neighborhood” flags as coded steering. “Guaranteed price” is an unverifiable claim. Any one of them can draw a HUD complaint. The editor’s domain rules live in a single swappable profile — point it at real estate and the same critique method enforces Fair Housing instead of medical-claim rules.

#### THE DETAIL WORTH NOTICING

The code caught the literal phrases; the human layer caught “*safe, family-friendly neighborhood*” — which the literal check missed because of a comma. Code catches the wording; the editor catches the meaning. And run against the realtor’s *actual* ad, the same check came back clean — a real result, not a rubber stamp.

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### CATCH 03

## Twenty seconds of silence.

*Source: "America's 250th" brand film — a real, shipped ad of my own*

### THE CATCH

Beats 1–7 carry no on-screen text, and there is no voiceover. The brand and the offer appear only at 0:20. A muted Reels viewer — which is most of them — watches a costumed man ride a hover-cycle for twenty seconds and never learns what it is for, or that there is an offer. Compounding it: the only treatment beat is AI-generated, so the ad has no real proof; and the payoff depends on decoding "Ann" (Ann Rutledge) and "Four Score" — clever if you catch it, a costume if you don't.

### HANDED BACK — NOT REWRITTEN

*"What minimal on-screen text could carry the regret-to-fresh-start line without stepping on the reveal?"*

*This was my own ad, and I liked it. The editor found what I couldn't see.*

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### CATCH 04

## "Your proof doesn't exist yet."

*Source: "Mother's Day" — a real, shipped ad of my own that the editor mostly **endorsed***

### THE CATCH

The two proof beats are marked *"to film."* The ad's entire credibility rides on footage that does not exist yet — if those beats get skipped, faked with AI, or shot off-spec, a well-built ad collapses into a text-and-AI piece. A delivery dependency rather than a design flaw, and exactly the thing that gets lost between storyboard and launch.

### WHY THIS ONE MATTERS

The editor did not manufacture problems on a good ad. It named three strengths to protect, then flagged the single thing that could actually sink it. An editor that returns a long fault list for a strong ad is miscalibrated — and that is the harder half of the job.

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Every run in the repo ships its exact input, the **verbatim** pre-pass output, and the full critique — all re-runnable, so none of this has to be taken on faith.

[github.com/craig-atr/fb-ad-editor](https://github.com/craig-atr/fb-ad-editor)